

Thursday, 24 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 22° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 21° 11°	MANCHESTER Overcast 21° 11°	GLASGOW Light rain 17° 8°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The RAF has paused fighter jet training after two pilots ejected from a plane before it crashed in North Wales.

The pilots of the RAF T2 Hawk aircraft are thankfully being treated for only minor injuries. Investigations into the incident are now underway.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 2

The UK is set to review its deal over the Chagos Islands after the US reportedly withdrew support, according to Defence Secretary Wes Streeting.

This comes after former US President Donald Trump apparently called the deal "terrible" to Prime Minister Andy Burnham. The islands have been a point of contention for decades.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

Police are examining a video that appears to show an anti-migrant activist slashing a dinghy with a knife.

Daniel Thomas, known as Danny Tommo to his followers, livestreamed the alleged incident. The video has sparked widespread condemnation.

CRIME · UK
- 4

A police worker has been jailed following the death of a nine-year-old boy who was in her care.

Catherine Walker was the legal guardian of the child, who was found unresponsive in his room. The tragic case has raised serious questions about safeguarding.

CRIME · UK
- 5

An on-the-run killer who absconded after attending his father's funeral has been arrested in the Republic of Ireland.

Gary Anderson had been unlawfully at large for over a week, sparking a major manhunt. His capture brings an end to concerns for public safety.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **Great news for Oasis fans, as the band has announced additional dates for their upcoming tour in Knebworth, Rome, and Munich!**

The new shows have been added due to "phenomenal demand" for tickets. It seems the Gallagher brothers' reunion is proving incredibly popular.

ON AIR – Are you hoping to grab tickets for one of the new Oasis dates? What's your favourite Oasis track?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **The judges for this year's Booker Prize have revealed their highly anticipated shortlist of novels.**

Among the nominees are past Booker winners Marlon James and Douglas Stuart, promising a fascinating contest. The judges described the selection process as a 'tussle'.

ON AIR – Have you read any of the shortlisted books? Who do you think should win the Booker Prize this year?

BOOKS · COMING UP

3 **Good news for Eurovision fans! The Netherlands has confirmed it will return to the contest in 2027 after boycotting this year's event.**

They didn't participate in this year's contest, but will be back for next year's competition in Bulgaria. It's always great to have more countries involved.

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to the Netherlands rejoining Eurovision? Who are you hoping will represent the UK next year?

TV · COMING UP

4 **London Fashion Week is trying to prove it's "bigger than London" with a new initiative this year.**

The aim is to showcase talent from across the UK, not just the capital. It's a move to broaden the reach and appeal of the prestigious event.

ON AIR – Do you think London Fashion Week needs to be more inclusive of designers outside of London? What's your favourite fashion trend right now?

FASHION · COMING UP

5 **The Prince and Princess of Wales shared a laugh with Hollywood star Tom Cruise at a film premiere this week.**

William and Catherine renewed their friendship with Cruise at the premiere for his new film, 'Digger'. They all looked to be having a wonderful time.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Tom Cruise movie? Is there a film star you'd love to meet?

FILM · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **Scotland's new head coach Sebastien Pocognoli is feeling a "positive nervousness" ahead of his debut game in charge.**

He'll lead the team in a Nations League tie against Slovenia in Ljubljana on Saturday. All eyes will be on his first performance.

ON AIR – How do you think Scotland will perform under their new coach? What's your prediction for the game?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Manchester City's Women's team fought back to secure a "precious draw" against German champions Bayern Munich.**

They recovered from being two-nil down to draw two-all in their opening Women's Champions League match. A fantastic display of resilience.

ON AIR – What a comeback! Do you think Manchester City Women can go all the way in the Champions League this season?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Will Jacks delivered a match-winning performance to help England to a comfortable victory over Sri Lanka in the first one-day international.**

His vital contributions with both bat and ball secured an 89-run win for England at Chester-le-Street. A brilliant start to the series!

ON AIR – What a performance from Will Jacks! Who do you think will be England's star player in the rest of the series?
CRICKET · UK

4 **Frenchman Isack Hadjar is set to remain as Max Verstappen's Red Bull team-mate for the 2027 Formula 1 season.**

This confirms a consistent pairing for the Red Bull team for the foreseeable future. It'll be interesting to see how they perform together.

ON AIR – Do you think Hadjar is the right choice to partner Verstappen? Who is your favourite F1 driver?
F1 · UK

5 **Wales' Women's team has suffered a blow with scrum-half Seren Lockwood ruled out of their second WXV Test against the USA.**

Lockwood failed a head injury assessment, meaning she won't be available for the crucial match. A tough loss for the squad.

ON AIR – How much of an impact will Lockwood's absence have on the Welsh team? Are you following the WXV Tests?
RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that the delightful scent of freshly baked bread can significantly improve one's mood.**
Researchers found that the comforting aroma triggers positive memories and a sense of well-being, suggesting a simple way to uplift spirits.
- 2 The trend of 'slow travel' is gaining momentum, with more holidaymakers opting for journeys by train or boat.**
This approach encourages a deeper appreciation of the scenery and local cultures, moving away from fast-paced sightseeing.
- 3 Gardeners are discovering the joy of 'micro-orchards', planting dwarf fruit trees in even the smallest of spaces.**
It's a wonderful way to enjoy homegrown produce, even if you only have a patio or a small balcony.
- 4 A recent survey indicates that a surprising number of people are taking up 'origami' as a calming hobby.**
The intricate art of paper folding is praised for its ability to focus the mind and reduce stress, offering a creative escape.
- 5 Experts are suggesting that collecting 'unusual pebbles or stones' can be a therapeutic outdoor activity.**
It encourages mindful observation of nature and creates a tangible collection of unique natural treasures from walks.
- 6 The charming tradition of 'leaving anonymous kindness notes' is spreading across communities.**
Small, uplifting messages are being left in public places, brightening strangers' days with unexpected positivity.
- 7 New research shows that simply 'watching fish in an aquarium' can lower blood pressure and anxiety.**
The gentle, repetitive movements of aquatic life create a calming visual experience, promoting relaxation.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cheese will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF – OR A VERY GENTLE SQUEEZE!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new podcast, especially if it's a long, detailed interview. What is it?

ANSWER: MAKING SURE THE HOUSE IS PERFECTLY QUIET – PERHAPS EVEN PUTTING A 'DO NOT DISTURB' SIGN ON THE DOOR!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of flower' just instantly brings a smile to your face, perhaps because of its colour, its scent, or a happy memory it evokes?

Which flower has that special effect on you, and why?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that, when someone does it for you, truly makes your day, don't we?

What's a small act of kindness you've received recently that really stood out, or one you love to do for others?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Plants.** Did you know that bamboo is technically a type of grass, and some species can grow up to 3 feet in a single day?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that ancient Roman gladiators used to train exclusively on a diet of lentils and a special fermented cabbage drink to build muscle?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£111 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£111 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's oldest known piece of chewing gum is 9,000 years old.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye.
- The average person walks the equivalent of five times around the world in their lifetime.
- Bananas are berries, but strawberries are not.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles is Ben Nevis in Scotland.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time: 1/100th of a second.

On this day

Day 267 of the year, 98 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Peru); Christian feast day: Anathalon (in Brescia); Christian feast day: Antonio Gonzalez; Christian feast day: Blessed Anton Martin Slomšek. Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Pat Pocock, Welsh-English cricketer
- 1965 — Janet Weiss, American drummer
- 1993 — Ben Platt, American actor, singer, and songwriter
- 1941 — Linda McCartney, American singer, photographer, and activist (died 1998)
- 1958 — Kevin Sorbo, American actor and producer
- 1946 — Jerry Donahue, American guitarist and producer
- 1970 — Marc Guggenheim, American screenwriter, television producer, comic book writer, and novelist
- 1952 — Mark Sandman, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer (died 1999)

THE DAY TODAY

- 2008 — Thabo Mbeki resigns as president of South Africa.
- 2023 — NASA's OSIRIS-REx capsule containing samples from the asteroid 101955 Bennu successfully lands back on Earth.
- 2015 — At least 1,100 people are killed and another 934 wounded after a stampede during the Hajj in Saudi Arabia.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1960 — USS Enterprise, the world's first nuclear-powered aircraft carrier, is launched.
- 2023 — NASA's OSIRIS-REx capsule containing samples from the asteroid 101955 Bennu successfully lands back on Earth.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1932 — Mahatma Gandhi and B. R. Ambedkar agree to the Poona Pact, which reserved seats in the Indian provincial legislatures for the "Depressed Classes" (Untouchables).
- 1975 — Southwest Face expedition members become the first persons to reach the summit of Mount Everest by any of its faces, instead of using a ridge route.

- 1935 — Earl and Weldon Bascom produce the first rodeo ever held outdoors under electric lights.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 268 of the year, 97 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day or Revolution Day (Mozambique); Bangladeshi Immigration Day (United States); Christian feast day: Abadir and Irajā and Companions (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Aunarius (Aunacharius). Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Mimi Kennedy, American actress and screenwriter
- 1984 — Zach Woods, American actor and comedian
- 1977 — Joel David Moore, American actor
- 1997 — Antonia Gentry, American actress
- 1968 — Will Smith, American actor, producer, and rapper
- 1969 — Catherine Zeta-Jones, Welsh actress
- 1981 — Lee Norris, American actor
- 2009 — Leah Jeffries, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1963 — Lord Denning releases the UK government's official report on the Profumo affair.
- 1964 — The Mozambican War of Independence against Portugal begins.
- 1937 — Second Sino-Japanese War: The Chinese Eighth Route Army gains a minor, but morale-boosting victory in the Battle of Pingxingguan.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1959 — S. W. R. D. Bandaranaike, Prime Minister of Ceylon, is mortally shot by a Buddhist monk, Talduwe Somarama, and dies the next day.
- 1998 — PaukAir Flight 4101, a British Aerospace 146, crashes near Melilla Airport in Melilla, Spain, killing 38 people.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar